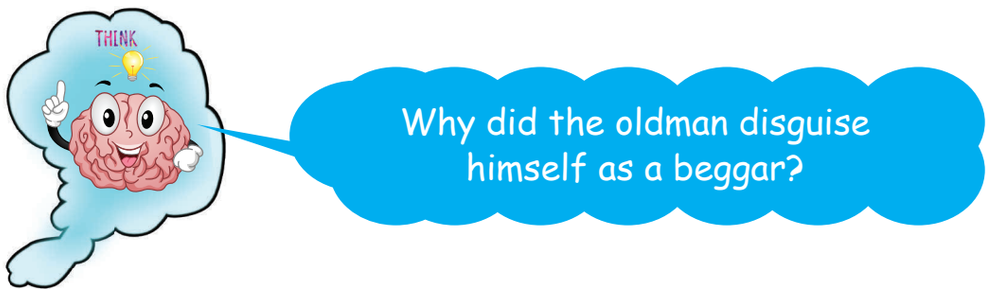
many questions and played with him. Kaliyan helped the man wash his face and hands. When the old man entered the hut, Viji was ready to serve the food. They all sat in a circle. Viji served the gruel from an earthen pot. At first she gave to the old man, and then to the children and Kaliyan. After the dinner, Kaliyan spread out a mat for the old man to sleep.

Next morning, the beggar asked them to pack their things. They all couldn't understand why he asked so. Before they could ask anything, the beggar said, "I am not a beggar, I am a land lord from a nearby town. My family and I were helping the poor and the needy. My wife and son died two years back. Without them I continued my service. As I grew older, I wanted someone to take care of my wealth and service after me. You have to accept my request and fulfill my desire." Kaliyan was **reluctant** but the old man **persuaded** him and his family. The old man was happy that his service would continue many more years even after his death.





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